UNITED REPUBLIC OF TANZANIA

PARLIAMENTARY RESEARCH ASSESSMENT

TANZANIA LIVESTOCK POLICY

STATUS OF IMPLEMENTATION AND SECTOR OUTCOMES TO 2025

Evidence review of the National Livestock Policy (2006) and NBS Annual Agricultural Sample Survey data

Assessment period: outcomes through 30 September 2025

Latest AASS report released: October 2026

RESEARCH REPORT

Prepared 9 November 2026

Prepared from the source documents supplied for this assessment

For research and analytical use; not an official parliamentary resolution or endorsement.

Executive Summary

This assessment reviews the National Livestock Policy of 2006 against the latest supplied National Bureau of Statistics (NBS) Annual Agricultural Sample Survey (AASS) evidence for the agricultural year 2024/25, ending 30 September 2025. The latest AASS report was published in October 2026; it is retrospective evidence about conditions through 2025, not information available to decision-makers during 2025.

The evidence does not support a blanket finding that the policy succeeded. Tanzania has a large livestock base and substantial production, but the data also show weak advisory reach, persistent extensive feeding, low milk marketing relative to production, marked productivity differences between indigenous and improved cattle, and a sex gap in livestock participation. The supplied material does not establish that these outcomes were caused by the policy or provide a complete implementation and expenditure record.

- Scale: 7.65 million agricultural households (76.9 percent) reported keeping livestock in 2024/25. As at 1 October 2025, the survey estimated 40.76 million cattle, 28.38 million goats, 10.24 million sheep, 3.74 million pigs and 113.59 million chickens.
- Productivity and commercialisation: AASS estimated 4.2 billion litres of milk in 2024/25, but only about 29 percent was reported sold. Indigenous cows produced an average of 1.6 litres per head per day in the dry season and 2.3 litres in the wet season, compared with 12.9 and 13.2 litres respectively for improved cows.
- Service reach: the AASS published rate for livestock rearing, production and processing information was 8.9 percent; 14.3 percent accessed agricultural market and price information. The denominator for the livestock-information percentage needs clarification.
- Production systems and resilience: 84.1 percent of holdings with indigenous cattle used extensive feeding. Drought or erratic rainfall affected 61.8 percent of agricultural households overall; this is an agriculture-wide measure, not a livestock-only shock estimate.
- Economic footprint: NBS reports livestock at 6.7 percent of Tanzania Mainland GDP at current market prices in 2025, valued at approximately TZS 15.69 trillion. Its share was 7.4 percent in 2021. A declining share does not by itself mean falling real output, but it does not demonstrate a rising relative contribution.

Overall judgment: implementation and outcomes are mixed, with material shortfalls in extension/advisory reach, productivity and market conversion. The policy's own framework assigns coordination and monitoring responsibilities, but the supplied policy and statistical reports contain no consolidated, time-bound scorecard linking commitments, budgets and outcomes. Parliamentary scrutiny should therefore focus on measurable delivery and on reconciling AASS estimates before treating the sharp 2024/25 participation increase as a trend or policy effect.

1. Purpose, Scope and Method

The subject is the National Livestock Policy (Sera ya Taifa ya Mifugo), issued in December 2006. The review tests whether its stated priorities are reflected in observable sector conditions, using the supplied AASS reports for 2022/23, 2023/24 and 2024/25 and the NBS Statistical Abstract 2025. The analysis is limited to evidence in the workspace; it is not an audit of Ministry expenditure or a causal impact evaluation.

The 2024/25 AASS defines its agricultural year as 1 October 2024 to 30 September 2025 and reports livestock stocks at 1 October 2025. This is the closest available end-period evidence. Since that report was released in October 2026, its results are used retrospectively to describe outcomes through 2025.

AASS estimates cover agricultural households and large-scale farms under the survey definitions. They measure reported participation, stocks, output, practices and access to information; they do not, on their own, measure policy implementation, household poverty reduction, national food security causation or the counterfactual outcome without the policy. The 2022/23 and 2023/24 participation estimates were approximately 60.6 and 57.3 percent, while 2024/25 reports 76.9 percent. Although the surveys refer to the 2022 Population and Housing Census frame, the supplied material does not provide a bridge or reconciliation explaining the 19.6 percentage-point rise from 2023/24. This assessment presents the figures as published and does not infer a trend or causal effect from that change.

2. Policy Commitments and Delivery Framework

The 2006 policy sets long-run aims of strengthening food security, reducing poverty and increasing national income from livestock. Its stated agenda covers livestock production and breeds; veterinary and animal-health services; feed, pasture, water and rangeland management; research, training and extension; livestock markets and processing; infrastructure; finance; and coordination among central government, local authorities, the private sector and development partners. The policy itself identifies disease, inadequate feed, weak markets and processing, land and water pressures, limited services, infrastructure gaps and constrained finance as barriers.

Implementation is assigned across public institutions and other partners, with local government authorities expected to carry substantial delivery responsibilities. The policy states that the responsible Ministry should prepare implementation strategies and plans and that monitoring and evaluation are necessary. The policy is principally expressed through objectives and policy statements rather than a quantified results framework: the supplied text does not set dated national targets for productivity, disease control, extension coverage, the marketed share of output or policy expenditure. This limits a retrospective pass/fail test and makes annual reporting essential.

3. Evidence on Sector Outcomes

3.1 Participation and livestock base

The AASS series shows that livestock keeping is widespread, but the published participation share varies substantially. The latest estimate is the highest of the three; without a reconciled series, the increase should not be treated as proof that the 2006 policy caused more households to keep livestock.

Agricultural year	Agricultural households	Households keeping livestock	Share
2022/23	8,970,096	5,434,209	60.6%
2023/24	8,971,794	5,144,067	57.3%
2024/25	9,955,356	7,653,167	76.9%

The 2024/25 stock estimate is large and predominantly household-based: agricultural households raised 99.8 percent of cattle, 99.9 percent of goats and sheep, 99.9 percent of pigs, and 96.2 percent of chickens. The policy's practical results therefore depend heavily on services reaching smallholder and mixed-farming households, not only large commercial operations.

Species (1 Oct 2025)	Total stock	Household share
Cattle	40,759,248	99.8%
Goats	28,381,442	99.9%
Sheep	10,241,004	99.9%
Pigs	3,736,326	99.9%
Chickens	113,593,096	96.2%

3.2 Contribution to the national economy

NBS's Statistical Abstract reports livestock at 6.7 percent of Tanzania Mainland GDP at current market prices in 2025, with a value of TZS 15.689 trillion. The share was 7.4 percent in 2021, 7.3 percent in 2023 and 7.1 percent in 2024. The estimates establish a material economic footprint; they do not show that the policy increased productivity or incomes. Current-price shares move with prices and with growth in other sectors, and should not be interpreted as a real-output series.

Year	Livestock share of Mainland GDP	Price basis
2021	7.4%	Current market prices
2023	7.3%	Current market prices
2024	7.1%	Current market prices
2025	6.7% (TZS 15.689 trillion)	Current market prices

The AASS estimated 4.2 billion litres of milk and 6.98 billion eggs in 2024/25. Separately, the Statistical Abstract's Ministry series reports 2025 Mainland production of 1.054 million tonnes of meat and 4.010 billion litres of milk. These series differ in source and geographic coverage (AASS includes Mainland Tanzania and Zanzibar); they are not combined or treated as a like-for-like comparison.

3.3 Productivity, feeding and market conversion

The most direct productivity signal is the gap between reported milk output per cow. Indigenous cows averaged 1.6 litres per head per day during the dry season and 2.3 litres in the wet season; improved cows averaged 12.9 and 13.2 litres. The survey also reports that 38.998 million of the 40.759 million cattle stock were indigenous. These figures point to substantial scope for productivity improvement, while not proving that breed alone explains the difference.

Feeding practice remains predominantly extensive for indigenous livestock: 84.1 percent of holdings with indigenous cattle, 79.8 percent of those with indigenous goats and 69.2 percent of those with indigenous chickens reported extensive feeding. Intensive feeding was more common for improved cattle (66.1 percent) and improved chickens (59.5 percent). The contrast is consistent with uneven intensification; it should be interpreted alongside local grazing systems and resource conditions, rather than as an automatic judgment that all extensive systems are unsuitable.

Only about 29 percent of milk output was reported sold in 2024/25. Output at this scale is not being fully converted into recorded market sales. The supplied reports do not quantify the reasons for the unsold share, so storage, household consumption, informal trade and processing cannot be separated from one another on this evidence alone.

3.4 Extension, information and institutional reach

The 2024/25 AASS reports 683,922 holdings accessing information on livestock rearing, production and processing and gives a rate of 8.9 percent. That percentage is consistent with the number of livestock-keeping households (7.65 million), while the table's displayed total-agricultural-holdings denominator would produce about 6.9 percent. The denominator therefore needs clarification by NBS. The same report gives 14.3 percent for agricultural market and price information, compared with 44.8 percent for weather information. Either interpretation indicates limited reach of livestock information against a policy that relies on technical services, extension and market information to improve productivity and commercialisation. The survey measures reported access, not quality, frequency or impact of advice.

The policy also addresses veterinary services, surveillance and disease control. The supplied AASS outcome tables do not establish national veterinary staffing, vaccination coverage, outbreak response time, disease prevalence or the functionality of laboratories and quarantine facilities. These important policy areas are therefore not rated as achieved or failed here; their status is unverified in the evidence supplied and requires administrative and audit data.

3.5 Climate, water and inclusion

Drought or erratic rainfall affected 61.8 percent of agricultural households in 2024/25. This is not a livestock-specific prevalence estimate, but it is relevant to the policy's emphasis on pasture, water and feed security. The AASS describes seasonal water shortages as a constraint and reports multiple water sources; source use alone does not demonstrate reliable year-round access. The high reliance on extensive feeding for indigenous cattle makes transparent measurement of dry-season feed and water availability especially important.

Livestock participation also differs by sex of household head: 78.7 percent of male-headed agricultural households and 71.5 percent of female-headed households reported livestock rearing in 2024/25, a 7.2 percentage-point gap. This does not by itself prove unequal service access, but it is a reason to require gender-disaggregated reporting on extension, finance, animal health, land and market access.

4. Policy Status Scorecard

Policy outcome	Evidence by 2025	Judgment
Participation and sector scale	Large reported herd and household participation; AASS participation series shifts from 60.6% to 57.3% to 76.9%.	Mixed; scale is clear, trend and policy attribution are not.
Productivity and intensification	Large indigenous cattle share; low indigenous milk yield relative to improved cattle; extensive feeding predominates for indigenous stock.	Weak / not yet demonstrated at broad scale.
Extension and market information	8.9% accessed livestock information; 14.3% accessed market/price information.	Weak; a measurable reach gap.
Commercialisation	About 29% of milk output was sold; output-to-market conversion remains limited.	Weak to partial; output is substantial, marketing is incomplete.
Economic contribution	6.7% of Mainland GDP at current prices in 2025; share lower than 2021.	Material contribution; no evidence here of a rising relative share.
Gender-responsive reach	Female-headed households' participation was 7.2 percentage points below male-headed households.	Gap persists; service and benefit equity is unverified.
Governance and monitoring	Policy assigns planning and monitoring, but the supplied record has no consolidated target-budget-outcome scorecard.	Not demonstrable from the supplied evidence.

The scorecard distinguishes sector presence from policy effectiveness. Livestock numbers and production are real outcomes, but they cannot be credited to a 2006 policy without baselines, targets, implementation records and a credible contribution analysis. Conversely, weak advisory reach and low marketed milk are directly observable conditions that warrant corrective action even where the precise cause is not established.

5. Overall Assessment

By 2025, Tanzania's livestock sector remained economically important and supported millions of agricultural households. The available evidence does not show that this scale translated consistently into higher productivity, broad access to technical information or high levels of formal market sales. The 2025 Mainland GDP share of 6.7 percent, compared with 7.4 percent in 2021, is a caution against describing the sector's relative economic position as improving; it is not, on its own, evidence of declining real production.

The most defensible conclusion is partial and uneven policy performance. There is evidence of a large livestock economy and important outputs, but significant delivery gaps remain in advisory services, productive feeding systems and market conversion. Policy effectiveness in animal health, disease control, poverty reduction, conflict management, environmental sustainability and infrastructure cannot be established from the AASS tables reviewed. The absence of a published, comparable results framework is itself a serious accountability weakness.

6. Priority Actions for Parliamentary Follow-up

1. Require the Ministry responsible for livestock to submit a costed implementation scorecard linked to each policy commitment. It should report annual targets and actuals, funding and expenditure, responsible institution, geographic coverage and outcome indicators; Parliament should receive it on a regular schedule.
2. Require a measurable extension and advisory plan responding to the 8.9 percent livestock-information access estimate. Report service coverage, visit frequency, subject matter and reach by district, species, sex of household head and delivery channel.
3. Direct the Ministry to present a productivity plan for feed, pasture, water and breed improvement, with an explicit dry-season component. Track functionality and access, not only the number of facilities built or inputs distributed.
4. Require a livestock value-chain dashboard using the 29 percent milk-sold estimate as a baseline for review. Track collection, cooling, quality compliance, processing, producer prices and marketed volumes, while distinguishing formal from informal trade and household use.
5. Request a veterinary-service and disease-control account: animal-health staffing and coverage, vaccination, surveillance, outbreaks, laboratory capacity, quarantine and response performance, disaggregated by species and region.
6. Require gender- and region-disaggregated reporting on access to extension, finance, land, water, animal-health services and markets. The 7.2 percentage-point participation gap should be investigated rather than assumed to represent either equal or unequal benefits.
7. Ask NBS and the Ministry to publish a comparability note for AASS livestock participation, including the 2023/24–2024/25 change, sampling and weighting adjustments, confidence intervals and any revised comparable series. Reconcile survey estimates with Ministry administrative production series and clearly state coverage.
8. Review the 2006 policy against current evidence and related land, environment, trade and industrial development frameworks. Any revised policy should include dated, measurable targets and a public monitoring mechanism from the outset.

7. Limitations and Evidence Gaps

- The AASS reports are sample estimates. Reported counts and percentages should be interpreted within their stated survey populations and definitions.
- The 2024/25 report is dated October 2026 but describes the year ending 30 September 2025 and stocks at 1 October 2025; it is retrospective, not contemporaneous 2025 reporting.
- AASS livestock participation estimates are not fully reconciled across years in the supplied documents. The 2024/25 jump is reported as published, not explained or attributed.
- AASS and the Statistical Abstract's Ministry series have different sources and geographic coverage. Their output estimates are cited separately and not combined.
- The AASS 2024/25 livestock-information count (683,922) and reported rate (8.9 percent) imply a livestock-keeper denominator, while the table displays total agricultural holdings; using all agricultural households gives about 6.9 percent. NBS should clarify the denominator before the rate is used as a performance target.
- The supplied material does not include a complete policy implementation plan, annual livestock budget and expenditure series, baseline indicators for 2006, or a government impact evaluation. Thus, causal attribution and a comprehensive rating of all policy commitments are not possible.

Sources

1. United Republic of Tanzania, Ministry of Livestock Development. Sera ya Taifa ya Mifugo (National Livestock Policy), December 2006. Policy rationale and commitments: printed pp. 3–4 and 8–43; implementation and institutional roles: printed pp. 44–49.

2. National Bureau of Statistics (NBS), Annual Agricultural Sample Survey 2022/23 National Report, September 2024. Livestock participation: PDF pp. 28–35; survey frame: PDF p. 26.

3. NBS, Annual Agricultural Sample Survey 2023/24 National Report, September 2025. Livestock participation: PDF pp. 24 and 27–32; survey frame: PDF pp. 22–23.

4. NBS, Annual Agricultural Sample Survey 2024/25 National Report, October 2026. Reference period and livestock outcomes: PDF pp. 147–149; cattle and milk productivity: PDF pp. 153–154 and 176–178; feeding and water: PDF pp. 184–187; shocks and information access: PDF pp. 188 and 193.

5. NBS, Statistical Abstract 2025, September 2026. Tanzania Mainland livestock GDP: Table 5.4, PDF p. 55, and Table 5.6, PDF p. 57; livestock and poultry product estimates: Table 6.5, PDF p. 74.

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